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Brand awareness: revisiting an old metric for a new world

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Abstract

Purpose – Brand awareness is a pivotal, but often neglected, aspect of consumer-based brand equity. This paper revisits brand awareness measures in the context of global brand management.

Design/methodology/approach – Drawing on the method of Laurent *et al.* (1995), this cross-sectional longitudinal study examines changes in brand awareness over time, with sample sizes of approximately 300 whisky consumers per wave in three countries: United Kingdom, Taiwan and Greece.

Findings – There is consistency in the underlying structure of awareness scores across countries, and over time, extending the work of Laurent *et al.* (1995). Results show that a relevant operationalisation of brand awareness needs to account for the history of the brand. Furthermore, the nature of the variation of brand awareness over time interacts with a brand's market share.

Research limitations/implications – When modelling the impact of brand awareness researchers need to consider two factors – the brand's market share and whether a more stable or volatile measure is sought. This avoids mis-specifying the country-level contribution of brand awareness.

Practical implications – Global brand managers should be wary of adopting a "one size fits all" approach. The choice of brand awareness measure depends on the brand's market share, and the desire for higher sensitivity or stability.

Originality/value – The paper provides one of the few multi-country investigations into brand awareness that can help inform global brand management.

Keywords Portfolio management, Brand awareness, Brand management, Market share, Top-of-mind awareness

Paper type Research paper

Introduction

Globalisation of markets is on the increase, and with it a rise in the global management of brands as more companies enter more countries (Lee *et al.*, 2008; Godey and Lai, 2011). As a result, a great deal of attention has been placed on how brand strategies differ across markets (Alashban *et al.*, 2001; Shrum *et al.*, 2012; Fetscherin *et al.*, 2015) because managers might need to devise strategies for a brand that is well established in one country, but still nascent in another. These circumstances lead to the question:

Q1. Is it possible to have the same consumer-based brand equity metrics for brands across countries?

Customer-based brand equity (CBBE) examines the value of a brand from the perspective of customers because this provides behavioural insights that can be converted into actionable brand management strategies (Christodoulides and Chernatony, 2004). Managers of global brands must evaluate the performance of their marketing strategies in different markets. This is an important step, because the systematic monitoring and follow-up of brand performance separates high-performing brands from their low-performing counterparts (Anselmsson and Lars Anders, 2013). Consequently the demand for global brand equity measurement has increased (Reza *et al.*, 1998; Hsieh, 2004; Christodoulides *et al.*, 2015).

There are many different models of brand equity; however, common across all is the inclusion of brand awareness as a key component (Aaker, 1991; Keller and Davey, 2001). Brand awareness is the degree to which customers are aware of the brand as a member of the category, and typified by the link between the brand and the category cue (Assael and Day, 1968). It is usually at the foundation of CBBE models, because brand awareness is the first step in building brand equity (Keller, 1993; Buil *et al.*, 2013). As the most common CBBE metric reported to company boards (Ambler, 2000), it is one of the most visible brand metrics in a company. This visibility makes the use of appropriate brand awareness

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metrics vital, for the marketing department's credibility. Therefore, we feel that it is timely to re-investigate brand awareness metrics in light of the complex global circumstances that brand managers often encounter.

Importance of measuring brand awareness

Pivotal to the importance of brand awareness is that it is a necessary requirement for higher-order constructs, such as brand image, to develop (Christodoulides *et al.*, 2015). Aaker (1991) describes the brand name as being a file folder in which all brand-related associations can be placed. Thus, brand awareness precedes brand associations, because consumers can be aware without holding a strong set of brand associations in memory (Christodoulides and de Chernatony, 2010), but they cannot hold a strong set of brand associations without being first aware of the brand. Because it is the first foothold, brand awareness is considered a particularly important metric for new brands, whereas brand knowledge and brand opinion become relevant for well-established brands (Çifci *et al.*, 2016). But even well-established brands face new category buyers, where awareness still needs to be established. Therefore, awareness is relevant for all brands, whether large or small in market share.

The final reason underpinning the importance of brand awareness is that it has been shown that brand awareness can itself facilitate choice (Keller, 1993). Hoyer and Brown (1990) demonstrated how people who know a brand name within a category, without prior purchase, will search less and select the known brand over higher-quality brands (in the absence of price considerations) (Celedon *et al.*, 2013). This has particular implications for product categories where it is very hard to judge quality, because of lack of experience and for low-involvement brands, for which the consumer is not motivated to seek out lots of information (Huang and Sarigöllü, 2012).

The commonality of brand awareness in marketing practice was confirmed by Ambler (2000), who found that 78 per cent of firms track brand awareness and this was the most common consumer-based brand equity metric reported to company boards as a measure of brand performance. More recently, 62 per cent of food brands tracking brand awareness each year, prioritised the metric second in importance behind product quality (Anselmsson and Lars Anders, 2013), whereas in Young & Rubicam's Brand Asset Valuator, brand knowledge, of which awareness is a major component (along with familiarity) is positively associated with customer acquisition, retention and profit margins in the automotive industry (Stahl *et al.*, 2012). This speaks to the broad relevance of awareness metrics, across different types of categories.

Measuring brand awareness

Operationalisation of a concept is a crucial part of testing, and Aaker (1996) suggests brand equity metrics should be sensitive enough to pick up change, be transferable across brands and reflect the construct being measured. For example, in PepsiCo and Frito-Lay's brand equity system, metrics were chosen to balance sensitivity, to detect changes, with stability, to avoid spurious effects (Kish *et al.*, 2001). Therefore, understanding the underlying response patterns highlights variation and variance across contextual factors such as categories, countries and brands, which aid in appropriate measure selection – whether stability or sensitivity is the objective (Rust *et al.*, 2004).

Researcher awareness of brand awareness is high (Pappu *et al.*, 2005), as is familiarity with this relatively simple, two-component, measure. The first component is the cue – which is the product category name (Aaker and Day, 1974). A typical example is "Which soft drink brands can you name?" The second component is the item for retrieval – which is the brand name. The strength of association in memory between the product category node and the brand node determines the level of brand awareness (Heckler *et al.*, 2014). The complexity in measurement arises when trying to decide the level of difficulty for retrieving the brand name, which is how the single concept morphs into three operationalisations to measure brand awareness.

The three most common brand awareness measures are referred to as top-of-mind, unaided and aided awareness. All measures cue with the brand, with differences concentrated in the nature and effort of consumer response. Both top-of-mind and unaided measures give the respondent minimal assistance to develop responses; thus, retrieval of the brand from memory is more difficult than when the brand name response is provided as for aided measures (Srull *et al.*, 1985; Laurent *et al.*, 1995). Of the two unaided response approaches, top-of-mind is the first unaided response given and is therefore the most difficult for a brand to achieve (Keller, 1993). While unaided awareness also comprises minimal cueing to remember the brand name, it does allow the mention of multiple brand names. In the easiest measure, aided brand awareness, the respondent is given the brand name as well as the category cue, with the overall aided brand awareness measure for each brand being the percentage of respondents that indicate "yes" (Huang and Sarigöllü, 2012).

When multiple measures are available, prioritising metrics become an issue. A small stream of research has compared the three different brand awareness measures, led by Laurent *et al.* (1995) who found that all three awareness measures followed the same underlying structure, and with the appropriate transformation, were potentially interchangeable. The major implication being that it did not matter which measure was tracked because each could be used to predict the others. The measures were in fact "tapping" the same source (within memory) and therefore the only thing needed was an adjustment for the differing degrees of difficulty of retrieval. However, the nature of the relationship between different awareness measures is logarithmic. This means that larger market share brands will vary more on more difficult measures (e.g. the more difficult unaided awareness rather than the less difficult aided awareness), whereas smaller market share brands will vary more on the less difficult measures. Laurent *et al.* (1995) concluded that different measures are needed for different brands, depending on where they are on the curve. They suggest that the measure that varies the most (e.g. top-of-mind for large market share brands, aided for small market share brands) will be the most useful for managers to track.

Romaniuk *et al.* (2004) longitudinally extended this research to reveal that the relationship between the measures for a single brand over time was more complex, and that

Journal of Product & Brand Management
Volume 26 · Number 5 · 2017 · 469–476

interchangability of the metrics was good for brands of medium market share, but poor for small or large market share brands. The variation found in the measures advocated by Laurent *et al.* (1995) appeared to be largely random in nature. Based on this, Romaniuk *et al.* (2004) advocated tracking the measure that did not vary much for a brand, because this would be the most reliable and therefore the one of most interest/importance when it did change. Both of these pieces of research suggest context matters, but neither dealt with the situation facing global or portfolio brand managers currently.

Despite the apparent simplicity of brand awareness as a measure, selecting a "one size fits all" approach is unlikely to be appropriate when tracking multiple brands within a portfolio or the same brands at different stages of development in different global markets. Hence, further research is required, particularly for global brand managers (Buil *et al.*, 2013). This research, if it holds across countries, has important implications for managers of global brands, where market shares often vary substantially for brands in different countries (Douglas *et al.*, 2001). Both Laurent *et al.* (1995) and Romaniuk *et al.* (2004) were conducted in a single-country context, and did not consider the context for global brand management. For instance, in recent research, top-of mind brand awareness varied across countries, with results reflecting the largest global brand in each country, Nokia in Finland, Apple in the USA and Sony Ericsson in Sweden (Hakala *et al.*, 2012). This research did not consider other measures of brand awareness that might be more relevant for, say, the brand manager of Nokia when examining the awareness of the brand across the four different countries.

Therefore in this research we address the following research questions:

RQ1. Does the similarity in the underlying structure of the three most commonly used brand awareness measures generalise across countries?

RQ2. Does the same model hold for brands of different market share over time within the same market?

RQ3. Does this hold for a brand with different market shares in different countries?

We then discuss the implications of this for a global brand manager when selecting a brand awareness measure to assess brand performance.

Past research comparing brand awareness measures

While there have been different studies that have advocated one form of brand awareness (e.g. the identification of top-of-mind awareness as a key metric in Axelrod, 1968), surprisingly few studies have compared the results from different brand awareness measures with each other. Laurent *et al.* (1995), in which the authors modelled the relationship between different countries, is the most prominent study to do this. They showed how a double-log transformation linearised the relationship between measures. Further examination, using linear regressions, revealed that the only difference between the measures was the degree of difficulty to retrieve the brand name. They drew on three key criteria to test their assertions:

1. The quality of the fit which was high – R^2 above 0.80 (they cite R^2s ranging from 0.82 to 0.91).
2. The constant, which represented the ratio of the difficulty of the measures, was strongly and significantly negative (all are around -2).
3. The coefficient of the line (β), which represented the quantitative relationship between the measures, was close to 1 (figures ranging from 0.85 to 1.13 were provided).

Romaniuk *et al.* (2004) followed the same procedure, but attempted to apply the same model to the scores for a single brand over time. They concluded that a large part of the good fit achieved by Laurent *et al.* (1995) was because of the fact that larger market share brands score more than smaller market share brands for all brand awareness metrics (a point also raised by Ehrenberg *et al.*, 1997). However, when tracking a single brand over time, if the brand has high market share or low market share, then one measure will be more volatile whereas the other will be comparatively stable. Because the volatile measure variability appeared to be random, with poor R^2 values from the brand level linear regressions, they concluded that the more stable measure was more reliable. However, this was a single study in a single country, and therefore needs further validation in other markets and categories.

In this research, we use the method used by Laurent *et al.* (1995) to model brand awareness scores from different measures for each of the different countries in this research. For two of these countries, we then extend the work of Romaniuk *et al.* (2004) to examine the models for large, medium and small market share brands over time. In all cases, two comparisons are made; top-of-mind awareness versus unaided awareness, as well as unaided awareness versus aided awareness. Finally, as an additional contribution specific to this paper, we examine instances where the same brand has different market shares in different markets, as might be the situation facing a global brand manager. From this, we draw conclusions about how managers of global brands should go about selecting the brand awareness measures to monitor.

Research method

For this research we draw on data collected as part of a global brand tracking study in the whisky market. Data were collected via telephone or face-to-face by trained market research interviewers. Three international markets, UK, Greece and Taiwan were included, to represent a diverse set of countries in terms of market maturity and history with whisky. The UK is a mature whisky market with a strong tradition from Scotland and neighbouring Ireland. While Greece is also a mature whisky market, there is no local history in the category and Taiwan is an Asian emerging market where whisky is growing as a category, and so is more dynamic in nature and represents the type of market most whisky companies are trying to successfully enter.

The time periods varied across markets, ranging from twelve waves in Greece spanning over six years, eight waves in the UK over five years and to four waves in Taiwan over three years. This allowed us to look across markets and over time. Sample sizes ranged from 211 to 300 category buyers per wave.

Journal of Product & Brand Management
Volume 26 · Number 5 · 2017 · 469–476

Respondents were screened prior to interviewing to ensure they did consume whisky in the four weeks prior to the survey, and therefore represented a sample of category buyers. Quotas for gender, age and income were put in place to ensure the representativeness of the samples, and respondents were also screened to ensure they were not involved in marketing, advertising or market research or worked for a whisky company.

All of the three standard brand awareness measures were tracked at the start of the questionnaire, prior to the mention of any specific brands, to avoid priming. The first question cued with the category (whisky) and countries (Scotch, Malt Scotch, Irish and USA) to maximise the range of brands that could be retrieved. Respondents typed in the responses, in the order of retrieval, and these responses were coded into brands. The order of response was also captured to identify the first brand recalled for top-of-mind awareness classification. A second question probed unprompted responses in more detail, asking "Which other brands of whisky can you think of?" and again multiple responses were captured. The unaided awareness scores are a combination of the brand's responses to the first two unaided questions.

The aided awareness question involved providing respondents with brand names and bottle images and asking them to tick a box if they had heard of the brand. This question is the first time a list of brand names was provided to respondents.

Results – underlying structure of brand awareness scores

The first stage of results was to replicate the analysis conducted by Laurent *et al.* (1995) on one wave in each of the three countries. Following the procedure outlined, we plotted the raw figures and found that as in the Laurent *et al.* (1995) paper there was a curvilinear relationship between aided/unaided and top-of-mind/unaided brand awareness. An example (from the UK) of the raw data and its curvilinear relationship is shown in Figure 1(a).

To replicate the assumptions made by Laurent *et al.* (1995), we followed the same double log transformation and analysed the linear data. We examined the linear regression equations (shown in Table I) using the criteria set by Laurent *et al.* (1995) – model fit, slope of the line (β) and the constant. The results are examined for all countries combined and then for each of the three countries separately.

Model fit

The model fit for "all countries", although not as high as Laurent *et al.* (1995), represented a good fit (Adj. R^2 = 0.66 (top-of-mind vs unaided) as did Adj. R^2= 0.73 (unaided vs aided) both statistically significant at $p < 0.05$ level). The quality of the fit is also good across all countries, both for top-of-mind versus unaided awareness (Adj. R^2 UK = 0.79, Taiwan = 0.71, Greece = 0.71, all significant at $p < 0.05$ level) and unaided versus aided awareness (Adj. R^2 UK = 0.69, Taiwan = 0.78, Greece = 0.72, all significant at $p < 0.05$ level).

The ß coefficient

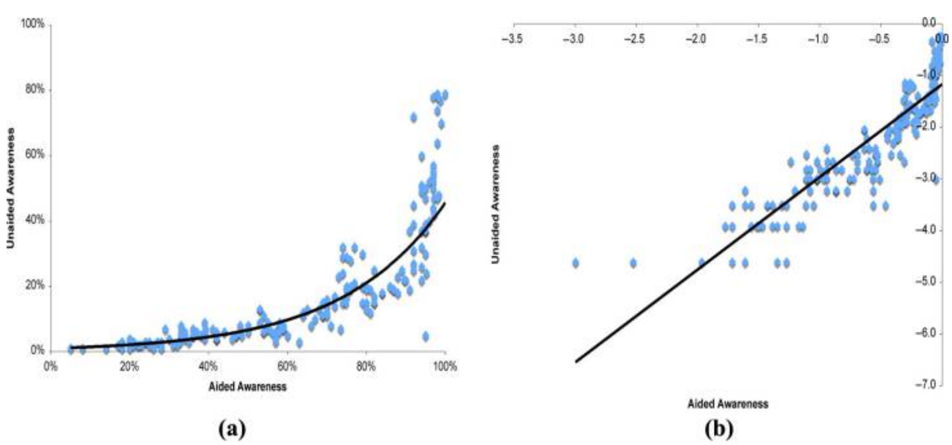
Across all countries, the coefficient of the line (slope) is close to one for unaided versus aided brand awareness measures (β = 1.02). This matches the expectation of Laurent *et al.* (1995) that the measures move in line with each other. However, for unaided versus top-of-mind brand awareness, the slope was steeper (β = 1.8). This suggests that for these two measures, the movement is not proportional but is at a ratio of about 2:1. The results for individual countries mirrored this, with Greece as a stand out with a slope of nearly

Table I Linear regression of awareness measures by country

Country	Top of mind v Unaided awareness			Unaided v Aided awareness		
	Slope	Constant	Adjusted R^2	Slope	Constant	Adjusted R^2
UK	1.7	−1.1	0.79*	0.9	−1.8	0.69*
Taiwan	1.7	−1.4	0.71*	0.9	−1.4	0.78*
Greece	2.9	−1.2	0.71*	1.1	−1.5	0.72*
All countries	1.8	−1.2	0.73*	1.0	−1.6	0.66*

Note: $^{*}p < 0.05$

Figure 1 Relationship between aided and unaided awareness (UK)



Notes: (a) Raw data (Aided/Unaided); (b) transformed data (Aided/Unaided) three, possibly because of larger market share brands. This suggests that while aided and unaided brand awareness measures follow the same quantitative pattern, total unaided and top-of-mind brand awareness differ.

The constant

According to Laurent *et al.* (1995), the constant represents the relative difficulty between the measures. The model structure means that the constant should always be negative, indicating the relative difficulty of the harder measure, and this is supported in our findings, both overall and within countries. The difference in the size of the constant across models suggests that there is a greater difference in difficulty between unaided and aided measures than there is between top-of-mind and unaided measures.

Summary

Our analysis successfully replicated the analysis by Laurent *et al.* (1995) across three different countries for comparisons between unaided and aided brand awareness, showing it applies to different countries – in this case UK, Greece and Taiwan. Additionally, we found that the shift from top-of-mind versus unaided awareness is easier than the shift from unaided to aided measures. Finally, the slope variation reveals that while a difference in unaided awareness scores is similarly related to a difference in aided awareness scores, the relationship between unaided awareness and top-of-mind is not as proportionate. Therefore, these latter two measures are less inter-changeable. This addresses the first research question, with evidence that yes, the model holds across countries.

Results – brand-level analysis

In addition to examining cross-sectional results, where one brand is compared to other brands in the marketplace, brand managers want to track brand awareness over time, which is articulated in *RQ2*. Therefore, we examine the issue raised by Romaniuk *et al.* (2004), which focuses on tracking awareness over time for brands of different market shares. Therefore in this stage of analysis, we examine brands in three market share brands (Big = above 60 per cent annual usage penetration, Medium = 30-60 per cent annual usage penetration and Small = fewer than 30 per cent annual usage penetration). The same first stage transformations and linear regressions were conducted and the results compared at brand level (Table II).

Table II Linear regression of awareness measures by brand size

	Aided/Unaided			Unaided/Top-of-Mind		
Brand size	**Constant**	**Slope**	**R^2**	**Constant**	**Slope**	**R^2**
Greece						
Big	−0.4	8.3	0.01	−0.6	2.5	0.86*
Medium	−1.7	2.4	0.59*	−1.9	1.9	0.83*
Small	−2.3	1.2	0.21	−2.0	0.9	0.21
UK						
Big	−0.4	3.4	0.12	−0.4	2.7	0.90*
Medium	−0.8	3.4	0.55*	−3.3	0.4	0.24
Small	−1.8	1.2	0.44	Insufficient data		

Note: $^{*}p < 0.05$

Model fit

The fit for medium market share brands is significantly higher than the other measures and better across both countries for the relationship between unaided versus aided brand awareness (UK $R^2 = 0.55$ and Greece $R^2 = 0.59$, $p < 0.01$). For top-of-mind versus unaided brand awareness, the fit is extremely good in Greece (Adj. $R^2 = 0.83$, $p < 0.05$) but not the UK (Adj. $R^2 = 0.24$).

For big brands, the fit was poor for aided versus unaided brand awareness measures, but good for unaided versus top-of-mind awareness measures. The scatterplots of the two measures reveal that this is because the large market share brands are similarly positioned on the curve as medium market share brands. This also explains the poor fit in the UK for medium share brands on top-of-mind versus unaided brand awareness measures, where these positioned much more often with the small market share brands, which have a consistently low fit across all models. Therefore, using the same market share cut off for classifying brands across categories can lead to misleading attribution of relationships and effects of metrics.

The ß coefficient

The ß figures indicate that each group is reflecting a different part of the curve, and that while the overall relationship may be a slope of one, segments of the market differ substantively. For example, the ß for medium brands is always between the large and small brand ßs such as in Greece: the large brands ß = 8.3, medium ß = 2.4 and small ß = 1.2. This supports the idea that for brand awareness measures, one model does not fit all brands.

The constant

The constant, reflecting the difficulty in remembering unaided over aided, indicates that it is easier for big brands to be recalled than small brands, with a constant of about −0.4 for large market brands and −2.0 for small market share brands (a five-fold difference). This also highlights the barriers that small brands face when trying to gain brand awareness.

Summary

To address the second research question regarding applicability to brands with different market shares, we find the unaided/aided model fits best for medium market share brands and relatively poorly for small and large market share brands. This shows that different models are needed for each brand, depending on their market share. The low R^2 values also support and extend the contention by Romaniuk *et al.* (2004) that the variance in the measure that differs more is largely random and unrelated to the other measure. Therefore, one measure for a brand cannot be used to interchangeably estimate the other measure over time.

This then has implications for the most appropriate brand awareness measures to be used for brands of differing market shares, as outlined in *RQ3*. Global brand managers often deal with situations where brands have been launched in different markets at different times, and so levels of market development and market shares vary considerably. To illustrate this point, let us take the case of a brand that has very different brand penetration statistics in two markets. Johnnie Walker Red is a large brand in the Greece (annual usage

Journal of Product & Brand Management
Volume 26 · Number 5 · 2017 · 469–476

penetration = 80 per cent) whereas in Taiwan it is a relatively small brand (annual usage penetration = 8 per cent). In Greece, Johnnie Walker Red scored consistently on aided awareness but inconsistently on unaided awareness. In contrast, in Taiwan where Johnnie Walker is much smaller, it scored consistently on unaided awareness but inconsistently on aided. Therefore, in terms of brand awareness, if a brand manager wants a stable awareness measure for Johnnie Walker Red, aided brand awareness should be monitored in Greece and unaided brand awareness monitored in Taiwan for "real" (as opposed to random) changes in brand awareness levels. However, if a brand manager is seeking something more sensitive (despite the risk of spurious results) as per Laurent *et al.* (1995), then the opposite measures should be monitored (Figure 2).

Overall discussion and implications

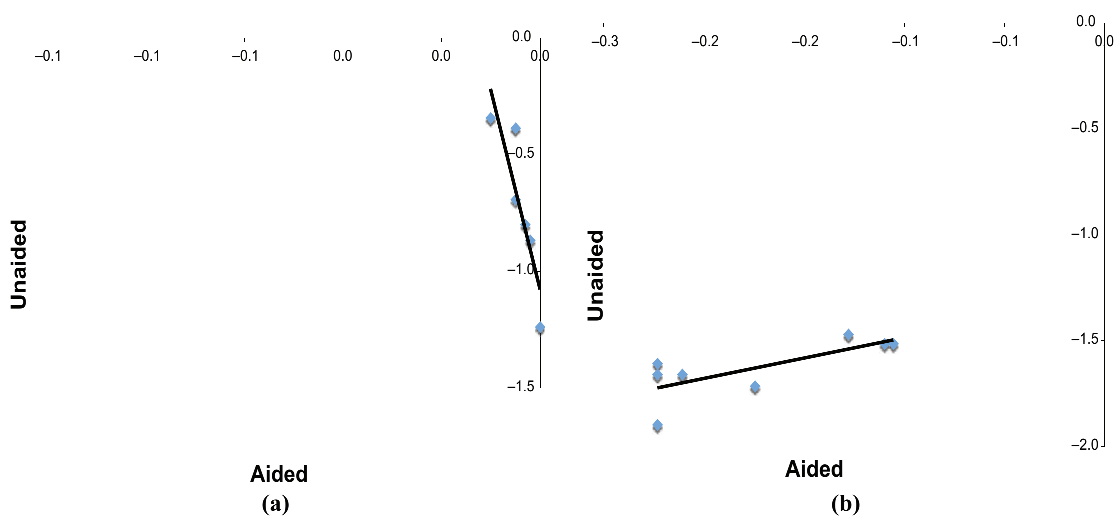
The aim of this paper was to update an old metric, brand awareness, for current global brand management situations. This is achieved by providing a more detailed insight into the underlying structure of different brand awareness scores, and how this might apply in a global context. This research highlights the importance for global brand managers to consider brand market share when selecting brand equity metrics. Christodoulides *et al.* (2015), noted the need for further research that allow meaningful comparisons across countries. We show the importance of adjusting brand awareness metrics to market conditions, that is, taking into consideration the brand's market share – rather than simply a one-size-fits-all approach. The best metric is the one that takes into account the brands' market share in that market, and so depending on this, global brand managers might need to be sufficiently flexible to monitor different metrics for the same brand, and also adjust those metrics if there are major changes in the brands' market share.

Our scope covered three international markets, as well as brands of different market share over several time periods. We found that while overall, the model proposed by Laurent *et al.* (1995) holds in all three markets, this does not mean that the measures are interchangeable. Further, the brand level analysis revealed substantive variations in the relationship between brands of different market share. Therefore, managers need to decide whether to choose more or less variant measures. Neither option is without risk because with more variant measures, there is a danger of spurious results, whereas with less variant measures, insensitivity is an issue; this is less of an issue than monitoring a single measure that might vary a lot for a brand in one country but vary very little for the brand in another country, because of the differences in market share. This is likely to lead to misleading cross-country brand performance evaluations.

This research also helps us build our knowledge on an important, but neglected, part of consumer-based brand equity in a global context. Much attention has been placed on brand associations and attitudes, but little recent fundamental research has been carried out on brand awareness, which is the most common brand equity measure that managers use, particularly for new launches. Therefore this research helps bridge the gap between global brand marketing practice and global brand marketing research.

The impact of a brand's market share on the metric also highlights the importance in taking into account past consumer experience when untangling the effects of consumer based brand equity. Researchers often neglect this, but not controlling for this is likely to suggest misleading implications about what drives a brand's equity, both when comparing brands of different market shares and when examining the results for a brand in different countries – where it might also vary in market share. The lack of control for market share also limits the ability to generalise experimental results (which remove past experience effects) to "real world" situations. Therefore it is important that global brand equity researchers look to develop insights based on methods that control for past

Figure 2 Relationship between Johnnie Walker Aided and Unaided Awareness (Greece 80 per cent penetration and Taiwan 8 per cent penetration)



Notes: (a) Johnnie Walker Red (Greece); (b) Johnnie Walker Red (Taiwan) experience, particularly when trying to assess the effectiveness of current marketing activities.

Guidelines on brand awareness measurement selection

This research also shows that brand awareness, although simple in structure, needs careful consideration when selecting which measure to prioritise for a brand. Two major factors need to be considered: the brands' market share and whether a more stable or more volatile metric is sought. Our results also suggest that as the brand undergoes major changes in market share over time, the measure that will be most relevant is also likely to change.

Therefore, marketing managers should make sure their brand awareness measures are relevant to the current brand status in that market, and not a reflection of history or their own personal preference. Based on our results across countries, we recommend a post hoc plotting of the scores to determine where the brand sits in relation to the brand awareness curve rather than trying to classify beforehand.

Small market share brands

If your brand has a small market share, it is most likely at the bottom of the curve, and so will vary more in the easier measures than in the harder measures. Therefore, TOM results will be more reliable, but prompted awareness measures will be more volatile.

Large market share brands

If your brand has a high market share, it will vary more for the harder measure than the easier ones. Therefore, prompted awareness measures will be more reliable, and TOM awareness will be more volatile.

Medium market share brands

If your brand is in the middle, then generally any measure will be fine, because this is where the relationship between all measures is stronger.

Limitations and further research

The limitations of this paper are predominantly to do with scope. It is limited to one product category across three countries. Additional testing in categories with differing market structures would further test the generalisability of the results. This research also relied on asking the same people all three questions (i.e. within-subjects condition). It would be useful to examine if these results hold when different samples of people are asked only one of these measures (i.e. between-subjects condition). This research did not address the question of what causes the random fluctuations in one measure but leaves another largely unaffected. Is it because different measures have a different propensity to be affected by marketing activities? This should be a subject of future research. Despite the longevity of brand awareness, and its foundation status in many brand equity and behaviour models, it appears that there is still considerable research and development that needs to be done.

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